

Thursday, 17 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Heavy drizzle 21° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Heavy drizzle 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Light rain 16° 12°	GLASGOW Light rain 14° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Heartbreaking news from the search for three-year-old Noah Woods, who went missing from a playground, as a child's body has been found.

Police confirmed the discovery in a nearby pond after extensive searches for the missing youngster. Our thoughts are with Noah's family at this incredibly difficult time.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

A former police officer has been found guilty of a shocking series of rapes and sexual attacks over a 17-year period.

Campbell Petrie, 50, was convicted of nine charges. The offences occurred while he was a Police Scotland officer between 2006 and 2023.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Residents in the village of Piddington have held a symbolic referendum, voting to leave the UK over plans for an asylum housing site.

The vote was in response to proposals to house over 1,200 male asylum seekers nearby. It highlights the strength of feeling in the community.

COMMUNITY · UK
- 4

The solicitor for the families of Lucy Letby's victims has blamed hospital bosses for delays in police involvement.

The Thirlwall Inquiry found repeated failures by hospital leaders to act on concerns about the former nurse. This continues to be a deeply distressing situation for all affected.

INVESTIGATION · UK
- 5

Ahead of next month's Budget, unions are pressing the government to raise tax thresholds among their key demands.

Unions who donate to Labour are meeting with John Healey on Thursday. They aim to make their priorities clear before the financial statement.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Welsh actor Matthew Rhys made history at the Emmy Awards, becoming the first person to win two lead acting prizes in one night!**

He described the experience as 'surreal' after his incredible double win. It's a fantastic achievement for the talented star.

ON AIR – What a night for Matthew Rhys! Have you seen his winning performances?

AWARDS · YESTERDAY

2 **Matthew Rhys's historic double win at the Emmys has everyone talking, so here are five things you might not know about the Welsh actor.**

He became the first person to scoop two lead acting prizes in one night. It's a great chance to learn more about the star of 'The Americans' and 'Perry Mason'.

ON AIR – Which of Matthew Rhys's roles is your favourite, and why?

FEATURE · YESTERDAY

3 **The stars were out in force on the red carpet at the Emmy Awards in Los Angeles, looking absolutely fabulous!**

It was the biggest night in the US TV calendar, celebrating the best shows and performances. From dazzling gowns to sharp suits, the fashion was certainly on point.

ON AIR – Who was your best-dressed star on the Emmys red carpet?

AWARDS · YESTERDAY

4 **Beyond the awards themselves, there were plenty of memorable moments and unseen gems from backstage at the Emmys.**

Winners continued their celebrations off-screen and shared insights into some of the ceremony's most viral moments. It sounds like a night full of fun and surprises!

ON AIR – What's the most memorable acceptance speech you've ever seen?

AWARDS · YESTERDAY

5 **Pokémon fans are getting ready for what's being called 'the biggest day in a decade' with a special 30th anniversary release!**

Collectors are eagerly awaiting the first release of the new Pokémon trading cards. Avid fans have been queuing, calling it a momentous occasion.

ON AIR – Are you a Pokémon fan? What's your rarest card?

GAMING · TODAY

On the schedule

1 **British racing driver Ollie Millroy says it's a 'miracle I'm alive' after a terrifying fireball crash, praising his rescuer.**

Fellow driver Loek Hartog 'did everything right' to save him from his blazing car. It's a testament to the quick thinking and bravery on the track.

ON AIR – What an incredible story of survival and heroism. It shows the dangers of motorsport, doesn't it?
MOTORSPORT · UK

2 **Four-time F1 world champion Max Verstappen showed off his incredible talent, passing 100 amateur karters in just 14 laps!**

The exhibition go-kart race at Silverstone saw Verstappen demonstrate his mastery. It just goes to show why he's a world champion!

ON AIR – Could you keep up with Max Verstappen on a go-kart track? I certainly couldn't!
F1 · UK

3 **What an innings from Harry Brook, who smashed a sensational century against Sri Lanka from just 42 balls!**

This incredible performance makes it the joint-second fastest hundred by an Englishman in a T20 International. He was in blistering form!

ON AIR – That's some serious power hitting from Harry Brook! What's the fastest century you've ever seen?
CRICKET · UK

4 **Manchester City manager Enzo Maresca has criticised the focus on Erling Haaland's controversial winning goal in the Manchester derby.**

Maresca believes it's 'quite poor' that the controversy has overshadowed his side's victory over Manchester United. It was certainly a talking point!

ON AIR – Was the VAR decision on Haaland's goal correct, or should it have been disallowed?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Match of the Day pundits Wayne Rooney and Danny Murphy found it 'baffling' that Erling Haaland's winning goal wasn't ruled out by VAR.**

They were discussing the controversial Manchester derby decision, but agreed Phil Foden's red card was correct. It seems the debate about VAR continues!

ON AIR – Do you think VAR is improving football, or is it causing more arguments?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A heartwarming trend sees neighbours sharing excess garden produce on 'swap tables'.**
Residents are leaving out surplus fruits, vegetables, and even homemade jams for others to enjoy, fostering community spirit and reducing food waste. It's a lovely way to get to know your neighbours!
- 2 The simple act of 'listening to the rain against a window pane' is being recognised as a top stress-buster.**
Research suggests that the gentle, rhythmic sound can induce a state of calm and aid relaxation, making it a natural antidote to a busy day. No special equipment needed, just a comfy spot!
- 3 Amateur stargazers are finding a new passion in 'identifying constellations with just the naked eye'.**
Away from light pollution, many are discovering the joy of picking out familiar star patterns without telescopes or apps. It's a wonderful way to connect with the cosmos, even on a cloudy night.
- 4 Community 'storytelling benches' are popping up in parks, encouraging impromptu chats and shared tales.**
These specially designated seats invite strangers to sit, rest, and perhaps share a short story or memory, creating small moments of connection. You never know who you might meet!
- 5 The joy of 'collecting vintage postcards' is making a charming comeback among enthusiasts.**
People are enjoying the thrill of finding old glimpses of towns and cities, often with handwritten messages from decades past. Each card tells a unique, tiny story.
- 6 A new appreciation for 'the art of perfectly brewed tea' is sweeping across the nation.**
From water temperature to steeping times, people are taking more care over their cuppa, elevating the everyday ritual into a mindful moment. A proper brew makes all the difference, doesn't it?
- 7 Local libraries are reporting a rise in popularity for 'classic poetry reading groups'.**
Members gather to share and discuss beloved verses, finding comfort and inspiration in timeless words. It's a lovely way to explore literature and meet like-minded people.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GOOD SQUEEZE AND SNIFF!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: DOING A LITTLE 'STEAM SNIFF' AND A CONTENTED SIGH BEFORE THE FIRST SIP.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular memory of an old sweet shop or bakery' just floods back to you, complete with the smells and the excitement?

What's the one treat or experience from a childhood sweet shop or bakery that you'd love to revisit today, and why was it so special?

- We all have that 'one particular comfort food' that, no matter what, can just instantly make a grey day feel a little brighter, don't we?

What's your ultimate go-to comfort food, and what is it about that dish that just makes everything feel right?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell' of petrichor, the earthy scent produced when rain falls on dry soil, is caused by a chemical called geosmin?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you whisper a secret to a 'Wishing Willow' tree on a full moon, your wish will come true within a year.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the Brookesia nana, can fit on a human fingertip.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The British Isles are home to over 15 species of bats, all of which are protected by law.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- Penguins can drink saltwater because they have a special gland that filters out the salt.
- The first crossword puzzle was published in a newspaper in New York in 1913.
- There are more than 1,000 different types of cheese in the world.

On this day

Day 260 of the year, 105 days left in 2026. Today Australian Citizenship Day; Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Eusepi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Keith Flint, English singer-songwriter (died 2019)
- 1946 — Billy Bonds, English footballer and manager (died 2025)
- 1962 — Paul Feig, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1940 — Peter Lever, English cricketer (died 2025)
- 1999 — Daniel Huttlestone, English actor
- 1938 — Perry Robinson, American clarinet player and composer (died 2018)
- 1979 — Billy Miller, American actor (died 2023)
- 1975 — Pumpkinhead, American rapper (died 2015)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2011 — Occupy Wall Street movement begins in Zuccotti Park, New York City.
- 1950 — The Republic of India formally recognised the State of Israel.
- 1978 — The Camp David Accords are signed by Israel and Egypt.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1976 — The Space Shuttle Enterprise is unveiled by NASA.
- 2016 — Two bombs explode in Seaside Park, New Jersey, and Manhattan. Thirty-one people are injured in the Manhattan bombing.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1980 — After weeks of strikes at the Lenin Shipyard in Gdańsk, Poland, the nationwide independent trade union Solidarity is established.
- 2006 — An audio tape of a private speech by Hungarian Prime Minister Ferenc Gyurcsány is leaked to the public, in which he confessed that his Hungarian Socialist Party had lied to win the 2006 election, sparking widespread protests across the country.

- 1961 — Northwest Orient Airlines Flight 706 crashes during takeoff from O'Hare International Airport in Chicago, Illinois, killing all 37 people on board.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 261 of the year, 104 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Constantius (Theban Legion); Christian feast day: Edward Bouverie Pusey (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Eustorgius I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1950 — Anna Deavere Smith, American actress and playwright
- 1933 — Robert Blake, American actor, producer, and screenwriter (died 2023)
- 1993 — Patrick Schwarzenegger, American-Austrian actor and model
- 1949 — Beth Grant, American actress
- 1973 — James Marsden, American actor
- 1974 — Emily Rutherford, American actress
- 1935 — John Spencer, English snooker player and sportscaster (died 2006)
- 1962 — John Fashanu, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — Two security personnel, 17 worshippers in a mosque, and 13 militants are killed during a Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan attack on a Pakistan Air Force base on the outskirts of Peshawar.
- 2017 — Toy retail chain Toys "R" Us files for bankruptcy protection in the United States and Canada.
- 2011 — The 2011 Sikkim earthquake is felt across northeastern India, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and southern Tibet.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2013 — A VIA Rail train crashes into a double-decker bus at a train station in Ottawa, Canada, killing six people and injuring 35 others.
- 2014 — Scotland votes against independence from the United Kingdom, by 55% to 45%.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar